

XP Exercises

Understanding Claude — Submission Template

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Date 16/08/2026

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Exercise 1 — Explain Claude to a colleague

Reminder: explain Claude to a non-technical Brightline coworker.

Field	Your answer
What Claude is (4–6 sentences)	Claude is an AI assistant created by Anthropic that can understand and generate human-like text. It can help with tasks such as writing, summarizing, analyzing information, brainstorming, and answering questions. Like other AI assistants, it learns patterns from large amounts of data and uses those patterns to generate responses. It does not “think” or understand things exactly like a human does. Its answers can be useful, but they can also contain mistakes or made-up information.
Auto-complete, in one sentence	AI works somewhat like a very advanced auto-complete system, predicting what words or pieces of text are most likely to come next based on the context.
Agreement / sycophancy, in one sentence	Sycophancy is when an AI agrees too readily with a user—even when the user's statement may be wrong—instead of challenging or correcting them.
Tokens, in one sentence	Tokens are small pieces of text that an AI processes, such as parts of words, complete words, or punctuation marks.

Practical advice (one sentence)	Treat AI as a helpful assistant rather than an unquestionable authority: verify important information and don't assume that a confident answer is necessarily correct.
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Exercise 2 — Turn a vague prompt into a precise one

Reminder: rewrite “Write me an email.” into a precise, positive prompt.

Field	Your answer
The vague prompt (given)	Write me an email.
Your rewritten prompt	Write a professional and friendly email to a colleague explaining that I will be unable to attend tomorrow’s meeting because of a scheduling conflict. Keep it concise, apologize briefly, and suggest rescheduling the meeting for another convenient time.
Two improvements that mattered most	1. Added context and purpose: specified who the email is for and why it is being written. 2. Added clear requirements: defined the tone, length, and desired action (suggesting a new meeting time).

Exercise 3 — Match the task to the right Claude

Reminder: choose Browser, Desktop, or Cowork and give a one-line reason.

Task	Browser / Desktop / Cowork	Why
Quickly rewrite a single paragraph	Browser	Best for quick, simple text tasks without needing files or complex workflows.
Summarise a 60-page PDF on your laptop	Desktop	Best for quick, simple text tasks without needing files or complex workflows.

Clean 30 invoices + draft follow-ups	Cowork	Best for handling a larger, multi-step task involving many files and actions.
Brainstorm taglines on the train (no files)	Browser	Ideal for quick brainstorming when you don't need to work with local files.